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VERSION 5

Global Best Practice



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to create excellent digital products!

Sample Paper 1

Answers and Rationales

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Published by PeopleCert International Limited
Published in Cyprus
Publication printed in Greece or reproduced electronically in Greece

Version 5.0 (March 2026)

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Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
1	C	1.1.4	A. Incorrect. The lifecycle does not define a fixed sequence that must be followed for all products. "Value streams: are the actual sequence of activities performed, rather than a predetermined blueprint." Ref 11.4 B. Incorrect. The lifecycle model integrates product and service management rather than separating them. "ITIL offers an end-to-end Lifecycle Model for digital products and services, where the concepts of digital product and service are integrated." Ref 1.2 C. Correct. This describes an integrated lifecycle model that applies shared stages across roles and operating models to support holistic product and service management. "The ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle includes eight stages. To manage digital products and services throughout the lifecycle [...] organization's role in service relationships." Ref 2.1.2 D. Incorrect. The lifecycle encompasses the end-to-end management of both digital products and digital services. It is not limited to describing transition and operation activities after products are built. "Digital product management (the management of digital product throughout their end-to-end lifecycle) and digital service management (the management of digital services throughout their end-to-end lifecycle) are both required to enable sustainable value for customers." Ref 2.1
2	A	1.1.1	A. Correct. Digital products are combinations of organizational resources that provide capabilities, while digital services are how those capabilities are used and consumed to realize value. "Products provide capabilities, while service offerings describe the potential value they offer to customers. When customers accept these offerings, service delivery and consumption begin." Ref 2.1.1 B. Incorrect. Value is realized through service consumption, not merely through the existence of a product. Also, digital services are not limited to internal operations. "Products provide capabilities, while service offerings describe the potential value they offer to customers. When customers accept these offerings, service delivery and consumption begin." Ref 2.1.1 C. Incorrect. Digital products are defined as combinations of resources, and services are where outcomes and value are experienced by consumers. A digital product is "a combination of an organization's resources based on digital technology and designed to offer value to consumers." Ref 2.1 D. Incorrect. Digital product and digital service are distinct concepts with different roles in value creation. A digital product is "a combination of an

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			organization's resources based on digital technology and designed to offer value to consumers," while a digital service is "a service that fully or largely relies on digital products." Ref 2.1
3	B	1.1.6	A. Incorrect. Governance influences and constrains decisions, but the value chain is not defined as a governance structure. "Formal governance structures support cross-functional alignment, accountability, and decision-making bandwidth." Ref 5.4.1 B. Correct. The value chain is not a governance layer, nor a replacement for lifecycle stages; it is the mechanism through which lifecycle management activities are carried out to enable value creation. Value chain is "an entire set of activities that enables value through the provision of a product or service." Ref Glossary C. Incorrect. The value chain does not reduce lifecycle stages to operational process execution. The value chain enables the management of digital products and services across all lifecycle stages, including 'discover', 'design', 'build', 'transition', 'deliver', 'operate', and 'support' activities. Operational execution is only one part of the lifecycle. Aligning lifecycle stages directly with operational processes ignores the broader management capabilities and value-enabling activities required throughout the entire lifecycle. "The operating model's core is its value chain: a set of activities that enables value through the provision of a product or service." Ref 2.1.2 D. Incorrect. Value chain activities are not sequenced into a fixed, linear process. They are combined and adapted as part of value streams, reflecting the actual sequence of activities performed rather than a predetermined structure. "Value streams: are the actual sequence of activities performed, rather than a predetermined blueprint" Ref 11.4
4	D	1.2.1	A. Incorrect. 'The 'discover' activity is not a one-time activity performed only at the beginning of the lifecycle. It is explicitly described as continual and iterative. "The 'discover' activity, from a product vendor's perspective, is a continual, iterative activity that defines which digital products to build, evolve, or retire, and why these decisions make sense in the broader organizational, market, and ecosystem context." Ref 3.1.2 B. Incorrect. Although 'discover' can be performed at organizational and portfolio levels, it is not exclusive to them. Product-level 'discover' is central to digital product management. "The 'discover' activity is performed at three levels: Organizational level [...] Portfolio level [...] Product level." Ref 3.1

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			C. Incorrect. The 'discover' activity frames and informs subsequent lifecycle stages but does not replace them. "It connects an organization's vision and strategy with actionable product portfolio decisions and thus frames all subsequent lifecycle stages of the digital products." Ref 3.1.2 D. Correct. The focus of the 'discover' activity at product level is to ensure ongoing alignment of product capabilities and service offerings with consumer needs and organizational strategy, which inherently informs future product direction and evolution. "The purpose of the 'discover' activity is to ensure continual alignment of the product capabilities and related service offerings with the needs of service consumers and with organizational strategy." Ref 3.1.1
5	C	1.2.2	A. Incorrect. Defining customer needs and prioritizing opportunities is the purpose of 'discover', not 'design'. "The purpose of the 'discover' activity is to ensure continual alignment of the product capabilities and related service offerings with the needs of service consumers and with the organizational strategy." Ref 3.1.1 B. Incorrect. Product and service design are inseparable in digital product management. "Digital product design should always include designing the future service interactions and service experience, so it is in fact 'digital product and service design'." Ref 4.1 C. Correct. 'Design' is broader than user experience or functional specification. Products and services are designed so they can be built, operated, delivered, and supported, not just implemented. "The 'design' activity aims to design products that are not only valuable and desirable to users, but also operable, supportable, and sustainable for the organization." Ref 4.1.1 D. Incorrect. Defining implementation tasks belongs primarily to 'build' and 'transition', not 'design'. 'Design' produces specifications and prototypes, not execution task lists. "The outputs of the 'design' activity serve as an important input to all subsequent activities of digital product and service management." Ref 4.2
6	B	1.2.3	A. Incorrect. Updating the backlog is part of planning and prioritization, not resource acquisition. "The key outputs of this activity include refined backlogs, updated product roadmaps [...]." Ref 3.2.2 B. Correct. The 'acquire' activity is about securing and allocating resources (including cloud capacity and specialist skills) so that approved designs and backlog items can be implemented across the lifecycle. "The purpose

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			of the 'acquire' activity is to secure and allocate necessary resources efficiently, ensuring the sustainability and scalability of products and services." Ref 5.1.1 C. Incorrect. Designing how resources are used belongs to the 'design' activity, not 'acquire'." The purpose of the 'design' activity is to create prototypes and specifications for products and services, detailing their functionality, user experience, and operational framework." Ref 4.1.1 D. Incorrect. Deploying features is part of 'transition', not 'acquire'. "The purpose of the 'transition' activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments and to ensure the effective onboarding/offboarding of suppliers." Ref 7.1.1
7	A	10.2.1	A. Correct. The model is intended to categorize AI functions based on what they do in service management contexts. "The model provides a functional classification of AI solutions." Ref 1.4 B. Incorrect. The ITIL AI Capability Model does not define maturity levels. It defines functional categories. "The model provides a functional classification of AI solutions." Ref 1.4 C. Incorrect. Governance comes in relation to AI adoption, but the Capability Model itself does not prescribe mandatory controls. "Organizations should ensure effective governance of technology and data they use and process" This refers to governance responsibilities, not the purpose of the AI Capability Model. Ref 1.4 D. D. Incorrect. The model does not measure financial return. Its purpose is functional understanding and classification. "The model provides a functional classification of AI solutions." Ref 1.4
8	D	2.2.1	A. Incorrect. Deployed features and service catalogue entries are not outputs of 'discover'. They occur after solutions are built and transitioned. "Products, services, and resources deployed to the target live environment and ready for operation." Ref 7.1, Table 7.1 B. Incorrect. Testing solution components is part of 'build', not 'discover', of which the key outputs are "Built and tested product solutions." Ref 6.1, Table 6.1 C. Incorrect. Operational performance data and incident trends are generated during 'operate', not 'discover', of which the key outputs are "Operating products and services; Product performance records and reports." Ref 8.1, Table 8.1 D. Correct. The 'discover' activity produces updated product roadmaps and refined backlogs at the end of its iterations. "The key outputs of this activity include refined backlogs, updated

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			product roadmaps, continual improvement initiatives, as well as reports and documentation of findings from the activity.” Ref 3.2.2
9	A	2.2.2	A. Correct. Assessing the product context means consolidating external and internal factors (such as regulations, market conditions, or user expectations) to understand constraints, drivers, and opportunities before defining problems or solutions. “‘Discover’ begins with an assessment of the current environment. Inputs include strategic direction, a PESTLE analysis, portfolio reviews, current roadmaps, backlog assessments, and feedback from other value chain activities.” Ref 3.2.1.1 B. Incorrect. Translating findings into detailed designs belongs to the ‘design’ activity, which follows discover after context and problems are understood. The purpose of the ‘design’ activity is to “create prototypes and specifications for products and services, detailing their functionality, user experience, and operational framework.” Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 C. Incorrect. Selecting platforms and services is part of obtain/acquire decisions, not an outcome of assessing product context during discover. “The purpose of the ‘acquire’ activity is to secure and allocate necessary resources efficiently, ensuring the sustainability and scalability of products and services.” Ref 5.1.1 D. Incorrect. Planning rollout strategies is associated with transition activities, not with assessing the product context in discover. “The purpose of the ‘transition’ activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments and to ensure the effective onboarding/offboarding of suppliers.” Ref 7.1.1
10	D	2.3.1	A. Incorrect. Deployment frequency is a metric related to ‘build’ and ‘transition’ activities, not ‘discover’. “Transition cycle (timeliness and duration).” Ref 7.1, Table 7.1 B. Incorrect. Mean time to restore service is a ‘support’/‘operate’ metric, not a ‘discover’ metric. “Speed of normal service restoration.” Ref 10.1.1, Table 10.1 C. Incorrect. Automated test coverage relates to ‘build’ and testing, not ‘discover’. “Quality of the product solutions.” Ref 6.1, Table 6.1 D. Correct. The purpose of the ‘discover’ activity is to ensure that products and related service offerings remain strategically aligned, market-relevant, and commercially viable. The key metrics of success are: “Strategic fit of the organization’s products and service offerings, market relevance of the products and service offerings, stakeholder satisfaction with products

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			and service offerings, commercial success of the products (if applicable).” Ref 3.1, Table 3.1
11	C	2.3.2	A. Incorrect. Finalizing direction without validating assumptions contradicts the purpose of the discover activity. “The purpose of the ‘discover’ activity is to ensure continual alignment of the product capabilities and related service offerings with the needs of service consumers.” Ref 3.1.1 B. Incorrect. Deferring validation until later stages increases cost and risk; discovery recommendations emphasize early validation. “A clear problem statement centres the team on value for real users, avoiding the common pitfall of investing time and money on solutions that don’t have a value justification.” Ref 3.1.3 C. Correct. Challenging assumptions with real user evidence is a key practical recommendation for effective discovery. “Decisions must be grounded in measurable data rather than intuition.” Ref 3.4.1 D. Incorrect. Prioritizing speed over learning undermines the purpose of discovery, which focuses on reducing uncertainty before design. “Delays and a lack of agility at this stage may become a source of constraints in other lifecycle stages and may ultimately lead to strategic failure of the organization.” Ref 3.2
12	B	3.1.1	A. Incorrect. Human-centred design does not prioritize minimizing iteration or starting from technology choices. It prioritizes user understanding and learning through iteration. “By grounding decisions in validated research, teams avoid speculative assumptions that often lead to costly redesigns later.” Ref 4.1.3 B. Correct. Human-centred design in ITIL emphasizes understanding users in context, testing with real users, and iterating prototypes based on feedback. “Human-centred design is a structured design approach that places people’s needs, capabilities, constraints, and contexts at the core of all design decisions.” and through “interviews, surveys, field observations, and analytics reviews designers refine the organization’s understanding of user goals, motivations, pain points, and the environmental constraints that shape experience.” Ref 4.1.3 C. Incorrect. Human-centred design in ITIL does not assume complete requirements upfront; it relies on learning and iteration. “This iterative process uncovers usability issues, validates design assumptions, and informs refinements before any code is written.” Ref 4.1.3 D. Incorrect. While reuse and consistency are supported through design systems, this alone does not demonstrate human-centred design unless

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			grounded in user research and testing. "By providing a shared vocabulary, a design system accelerates design and development, reduces duplication of effort, and maintains brand coherence at scale." Ref 4.1.3
13	A	10.2.4	A. Correct. ITIL is positioned as the framework for digital product and service management, while DevOps provides complementary practices and techniques that enhance lifecycle activities. The collaboration is described as a combination of ITIL's framework and DevOps' methods. "While ITIL provides a robust framework for digital product and service management, many enterprises are now integrating DevOps practices to accelerate product development and optimize product operation." Also, "While ITIL® provides the framework for effective digital product and service management, no single framework is enough for successful work in today's diverse business and technology ecosystems." Ref 12.5.1 B. Incorrect. DevOps is described as an extension and complementary approach, not something that is replaced by ITIL processes. "Certifications such as PRINCE2® (for agile project, programme, and portfolio management) and those from the DEVOPS INSTITUTE® (DOI, for agile, continuous product development and operation) offer powerful extensions to the ITIL framework." Ref 12.5 C. Incorrect. DevOps is linked to multiple lifecycle activities across the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle, not restricted to software development alone. "DevOps is a valuable complementary approach which should be used as a source of detailed practical advice enabling such activities of the ITIL Product and Service Lifecycle as 'discover', 'design', 'acquire', 'build', 'transition', and 'operate'." Ref 12.5.1 D. Incorrect. The text clearly positions ITIL as the framework and DevOps as an extension to it, not as a governance layer above ITIL. "While ITIL® provides the framework for effective digital product and service management, no single framework is enough for successful work in today's diverse business and technology ecosystems." Ref 12.5
14	C	3.2.2	A. Incorrect. Defining monitoring thresholds is part of the 'operate' activity, not 'design'. "The purpose of the 'operate' activity is to maintain and monitor digital products and services and supporting systems, ensuring optimal performance and reliability." Ref 8.1.1 B. Incorrect. Feature prioritization is driven by discover outputs and portfolio decisions, not by design steps. "The high-level workflow of the

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			'discover' activity comprises four steps [...] Prioritize actions and allocate resources." Ref 3.2 C. Correct. Producing architectural designs is a key step of the 'design' activity. "The 'design' activity translates strategic intent into concrete solution designs that can be built, operated, and supported effectively by service providers." Ref 4.1.2 D. Incorrect. Planning phased releases is part of the 'transition' activity, not design. "The purpose of the 'transition' activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments [...]." Ref 7.1.1
15	A	3.3.1	A. Correct. A critical success factor of the 'design' activity is early and ongoing cross-functional collaboration, especially with teams responsible for 'build', 'transition', 'operate', 'deliver', and 'support', to prevent downstream rework. "Cross-disciplinary collaboration and shared ownership." Ref 4.4.3, Table 4.5 B. Incorrect. Increasing deployment frequency is not a 'design' improvement action; it relates to 'transition' or 'operate'. "The purpose of the 'transition' activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments [...]." Ref 7.1.1 C. Incorrect. Automation improves 'build' efficiency but does not directly address design effectiveness or rework. "The 'build' activity can and should be highly automated, enabling continuous integration." Ref 6.1.3 D. Incorrect. Analysis of live service incidents belongs to 'operate' and 'support', not 'design'. "Product performance records and reports." Ref 8.1, Table 8.1
16	A	3.3.2	A. Correct. Applying iterative validation ensures designs remain aligned with real needs and constraints. "The design of digital products is performed in iterations and experiments, and includes checkpoints with service providers and users." Ref 4.1.2.3 B. Incorrect. Freezing the design early to reduce rework contradicts the iterative and experimental nature of effective design, which includes validation checkpoints before finalization. "The design of digital products is performed in iterations and experiments, and includes checkpoints with service providers and users." Ref 4.1.2.3 C. Incorrect. Delegating design decisions without shared validation undermines collaboration and design quality. "Effective design emerges from collaboration among product managers, developers, engineers, researchers, and marketers." Ref 4.4.1 D. Incorrect. Restricting design input to documentation alone ignores learning through

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			interaction and feedback, which is discouraged. "Designers make no assumptions that work done through the 'discover' activity is complete, accurate, or even still valid." Ref 4.2.1.1
17	C	8.1.2	A. Incorrect. Service request management focuses on fulfilling user requests rather than defining, monitoring, or reporting overall service quality. "Service request management: Fulfilling service requests." Ref 9.3 Table 9.2 B. Incorrect. Knowledge management supports delivery by organizing and providing knowledge, but it does not define or monitor service quality. "Knowledge management: Captures, organizes, and provides service-related knowledge and advice." Ref 9.3 Table 9.3 C. Correct. Service level management is the practice responsible for managing and reporting service quality, directly aligning with defining, monitoring, and reporting service performance during delivery. "Service level management: Managing and reporting of service quality." Ref 9.3 Table 9.2 D. Incorrect. Monitoring and event management tracks service delivery performance but does not define or manage service quality commitments. "Monitoring and event management: Monitoring and reporting service delivery." Ref 9.3 Table 9.2
18	D	4.2.1	A. Incorrect. Approved designs and architectural models are outputs of the 'design' activity, not 'acquire'. "Product specifications and prototypes." Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 B. Incorrect. Integrated and tested components are outputs of the 'build' activity. "Built and tested product solutions." Ref 6.1, Table 6.1 C. Incorrect. Deployed services are outputs of 'transition' and 'delivery' activities. "Products, services, and resources deployed to the target live environment and ready for operation." Ref 7.1, Table 7.1 D. Correct. The 'acquire' activity is completed when resources and services have been secured and allocated, and agreements are in place, enabling subsequent 'build' and 'operate' activities. "The key outputs are: approved resource requests, new or modified agreements (SLA, Terms and Conditions, licence agreements), new and modified configuration items and assets, new partners or suppliers." Ref 5.2.2
19	C	4.2.2	A. Incorrect. Deployment speed is a 'transition' concern and does not provide sufficient insight into suitability or sustainability of sourcing options. The 'acquire' activity aims to quickly identify and allocate necessary resources to optimize the value outcomes of new and modified products while minimizing waste and expense." Ref 5.1.1

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			B. Incorrect. Cost is an important factor, but selecting solely on cost ignores capability, compliance, and integration risks emphasized in the 'acquire' activity. "Total cost of ownership: what are the costs over the lifecycle of the product for licences, support, training, depreciation, and replacement?" Ref 5.1.4 C. Correct. Evaluating options holistically against these criteria demonstrates correct application of the sourcing assessment step. "When this happens, sourcing options must be assessed, and new contracts or agreements need to be arranged." Ref 5.1.3 D. Incorrect. Delivery team preference alone does not address strategic, regulatory, or lifecycle considerations required when assessing sourcing options. "Clear communication of the decision matrix, ownership of budgets, and portfolio and procurement management policies allow the appropriate decisions to be made [...]" Ref 5.1.3
20	C	4.3.1	A. Incorrect. Automation of build and test activities belongs to 'build', not 'acquire'. "The 'build' activity can and should be highly automated, enabling continuous integration." Ref 6.1.3 B. Incorrect. Accelerating approvals for releases relates to 'transition', not 'acquire'. "The purpose of the 'transition' activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments [...]" Ref 7.1.1 C. Correct. A critical success factor of the 'acquire' activity is ensuring that resources and suppliers are secured in alignment with the product roadmap and timelines. Delivery delays caused by unavailable tools and services directly indicate poor coordination in 'acquire'. "Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines." Ref 5.1, Table 5.1 D. Incorrect. Incident resolution speed is a 'support' concern, not related to 'acquire' delays. "Speed of normal service restoration." Ref 10.1.1, Table 10.1
21	B	4.3.2	A. Incorrect. Full standardization may ignore regulatory constraints and contradicts effective acquisition guidance. "Regulations, standards, insurers, and investors may constrain most acquisition choices about digital products and their required capabilities for storage, transit, use, security, categorization, and retention of data and information." Ref 5.1.4 B. Correct. A key practical recommendation for effective acquisition is to consider regulatory, compliance, and integration requirements early, before committing to suppliers. Addressing these factors early reduces risk and rework. "When acquiring these resources externally, it is especially important to consider intellectual

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			property rights, data ownership and sovereignty, and global compliance and regulations.” Ref 5.1.4 C. Incorrect. Independent contracting without coordination increases fragmentation and risk. “Clear communication of the decision matrix, ownership of budgets, and portfolio and procurement management policies allow the appropriate decisions to be made [...]” Ref 5.1.3 D. Incorrect. Addressing compliance after go-live exposes the organization to avoidable risk. “Careful consideration should be taken to determine if these resources should be acquired externally or assembled internally. [...] especially important to consider [...] global compliance and regulations.” Ref 5.1.4
22	D	5.1.1	A. Incorrect. Build activities are not independent of design; design prepares solutions so they can be built and supported effectively. “The ‘design’ activity translates strategic intent into concrete solution designs that can be built, operated, and supported effectively by service providers, while enabling the intended outcomes for end users.” Ref 4.1.2 B. Incorrect. ‘Design’ produces implementation-ready artefacts, not just early planning outputs. “Product specifications and prototypes.” Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 C. Incorrect. Validating user needs is primarily part of ‘discover’, while ‘build’ focuses on developing solutions based on ‘design’. “The purpose of the ‘discover’ activity is to ensure continual alignment of the product capabilities and related service offerings with the needs of service consumers and with the organizational strategy.” Ref 3.1.1 D. Correct. ‘Build’ depends on ‘design’ outputs, and ‘design’ outputs are inputs to subsequent lifecycle management activities, showing tight coordination. “The outputs of the ‘design’ activity serve as an important input to all subsequent activities of digital product and service management.” Ref 4.2
23	D	5.2.1	A. Incorrect. ‘Design’ specifications and prototypes are outputs of the ‘design’ activity, not of ‘build’. “Product specifications and prototypes.” Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 B. Incorrect. Contracted services and allocated resources are outputs of the ‘acquire’ activity. “Acquired resources and services.” Ref 5.1, Table 5.1 C. Incorrect. Operational reports and incident data are produced during the ‘operate’ activity. “Operating products and services. Product performance records and reports.” Ref 8.1, Table 8.1 D. Correct. The ‘build’ activity produces built and tested product solutions, which are then ready to move into ‘transition’. “Built and tested product solutions.” Ref 6.1, Table 6.1

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24	A	5.2.2	A. Correct. The first step of the 'build' activity is assessing the solution design to ensure that what will be built aligns with the approved design specifications and expected outcomes before development begins. This includes structuring build work so that components clearly reflect the agreed design. The steps of the 'build' activity are: "Assess solution design. Plan building and testing and confirm resource availability. Execute building and testing plans. Deliver solutions and supporting documentation." Ref 6.2, 6.2.1.1 B. Incorrect. Scheduling deployment windows is part of the 'transition' activity, not the 'build' activity. "The purpose of the 'transition' activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments [...]." Ref 7.1.1 C. Incorrect. Training support teams are associated with transition and support readiness, not build. "A key aspect of product-level transition is training and enablement for both service provider staff and, where appropriate, customer personnel." Ref 7.1.2.2 D. Incorrect. Feature prioritization is driven by discovery and portfolio decisions, not performed as a step within 'build'. "The high-level workflow of the 'discover' activity comprises four steps [...]. Prioritize actions and allocate resources." Ref 3.2
25	B	5.3.1	A. Incorrect. This is about release approval speed, which is a primary reason for collaboration in the 'build' activity. The 'build' activity is concerned with constructing and validating solutions so that they are technically sound and ready for subsequent lifecycle stages. While release speed may be influenced by good build practices, collaboration is not a mechanism for accelerating approvals. "The goal of assessing the solution design is to ensure: That the design requirements are clear and that the build specifications will contribute the expected value." Ref 6.2.1.1 B. Correct. 'Build' requires coordination between product managers, business analysts, architects, and development teams to break down design into build units and ensure feasibility, verifiability, and integration readiness. Collaboration is essential to confirm that the 'build' model is fit for purpose and that outcomes can be validated through testing. "The build requirements are discussed with the product manager, business analysts and technical and architectural leads. The goal of the solution design assessment is to break the solution design into specific build specifications and build units." Ref 6.2.1.1 C. Incorrect. Prioritization of product ideas is not a core objective of 'build'. That activity is handled

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			earlier in the lifecycle (particularly in 'discover' and 'design'). Executing is based on defined specifications. The emphasis is on transforming 'design' into 'build' units and ensuring technical feasibility. "A key concept of waterfall models is structuring the build specifications and build units sequentially from start to finish to facilitate aligning and scheduling resources and dependencies and ensure a continual progression from 'design' to 'operate'." Ref 6.2.1.1 D. Incorrect. Customer communication during service delivery and operation belongs to later lifecycle stages such as 'deliver' and 'operate', not 'build'. The focus here is on development execution, technical validation, and readiness for transition. While 'build' output eventually affects customers, the collaboration is internal and technical in nature. "How, and by whom, will the solution be transitioned, operated, delivered, and supported?" Ref 6.2.1
26	A	8.2.2	A. Correct. The scenario describes reviewing existing SLAs and onboarding procedures before activating the feature. This corresponds precisely to the first step of the 'deliver' activity, which requires reviewing commitments defined in service agreements prior to delivery execution. "Deliver' begins by reviewing the commitments defined in service agreements. This includes assessing SLAs, service requests, and events that may impact delivery. The goal is to ensure that delivery is grounded in clearly defined expectations and that any risks to performance or availability are identified early." Ref 9.2.1.1 B. Incorrect. This step occurs after commitments have been reviewed and clarified. It involves confirming procedures, tools, and resource availability. The scenario does not describe confirming delivery plans or resource allocation. "Once commitments are clear, providers create or adapt a delivery plan. This involves confirming the procedures, tools, and resources (such as staff, suppliers, and automation capabilities) required to meet commitments. Plans also establish roles and responsibilities to ensure accountability during delivery." Ref 9.2.1.2 C. Incorrect. Execution occurs only after assessment and planning have been completed. The feature has not yet been activated; therefore, delivery execution has not started. "The final step is execution: fulfilling service requests, carrying out onboarding and offboarding, or completing scheduled service actions. Delivery does not end with fulfilment; it also involves capturing evidence, reporting outcomes, and gathering user feedback." Ref 9.2.1.3

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			D. Incorrect. Incident capture and recovery actions belong to the 'support' activity, which is triggered when incidents or disruptions occur. The scenario describes preparatory review, not incident response. "The purpose of the 'support' activity is to identify and resolve incidents, fulfil disaster recovery procedures, and capture consumer's feedback." Ref 10.1.1
27	C	6.1.1	A. Incorrect. This describes a single "big-bang" release. But 'transition' can involve many updates deployed in a short timeframe. "In a digital product environment, the 'transition' activity may be highly or fully automated, allowing for many product or component updates to be deployed in a short timeframe." Ref 7.2 B. Incorrect. This describes a single release event. 'Transition' happens as frequently as needed, triggered by new built solutions or acquired resources. "As frequently as needed, triggered by built solutions or acquired resources and services (subject to the organization's deployment policies and guidelines)." Ref 7.1, Table 7.1 C. Correct. It is suggested that 'transition' takes place in incremental and phased releases to reduce risk and enable learning and adjustment between releases. "In a digital product environment, the 'transition' activity may be highly or fully automated, allowing for many product or component updates to be deployed in a short timeframe." Ref 7.2 D. Incorrect. 'Transition' as triggered by built solutions/acquired resources and is performed as frequently as needed. 'Transition' is part of getting things into the live environment. "As frequently as needed, triggered by built solutions or acquired resources and services (subject to the organization's deployment policies and guidelines)." Ref 7.1, Table 7.1
28	C	6.2.1	A. Incorrect. Design specifications and architecture models are outputs of 'design', not 'transition' or 'support'. The key outputs for the 'design' activity are "Product specifications and prototypes." Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 B. Incorrect. Supplier contracts and allocated resources are outputs of 'acquire', not related to post-transition usability or 'support'. The key outputs for the 'acquire' activity are "Acquired resources and services." Ref 5.1, Table 5.1 C. Correct. After 'transition', a product must be usable and supportable. Operational documentation, knowledge, and support readiness enable effective use and ongoing support. "Each 'transition' cycle addresses both the knowns and unknowns: ensuring that environments are ready, documentation is

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			complete, dependencies are satisfied, and teams are aligned.” Ref 7.2.1 D. Incorrect. Defect logs are associated with ‘build’, not with ensuring effective use and support after transition. The key outputs for the ‘build’ activity are “Built and tested product solutions.” Ref 6.1, Table 6.1
29	C	6.2.2	A. Incorrect. Checking the live environment after release is reactive and occurs too late. Transition preparation is about ensuring readiness before execution, not post-release validation. “The purpose of the ‘transition’ activity is to seamlessly introduce new or updated products and services into operational environments [...]” Ref 7.1.1 B. Incorrect. Post-transition debriefs occur after execution, not during preparation. They are valuable, but they do not convert assessment outputs into actionable readiness. “Within one to two days, a post-transition debrief takes place to capture lessons learned, recognize achievements, and identify improvement opportunities.” Ref 7.2.1.3 C. Correct. After assessing solutions and transition requirements, the next core transition step is to plan transition activities and confirm resource availability. “The four steps of the ‘transition’ activity are: Assess solutions and transition requirements. Plan transition activities and confirm resource availability. Execute transition plans. Communicate transition results to stakeholders.” Ref 7.2 D. Incorrect. Transition results reporting happens after transition execution, not during preparation. “Communicate transition results to stakeholders.” Ref 7.2
30	B	6.3.2	A. Incorrect. Assuming automatic alignment increases risk and contradicts structured handoff guidance. “Transition is not just about deployment. It’s about preparing the entire ecosystem to run.” Ref 7.1.1 B. Correct. The scenario highlights that “supplier onboarding was critical,” and the guidance recommends formalizing ownership and escalation paths to avoid post-transition instability. “Onboarding suppliers is also considered a form of transition.” and ““Transition’ includes ensuring that the new or updated products are integrated into the live environment and are ready for product operation and service delivery.” Ref 7.1 C. Incorrect. Contract management alone does not ensure operational readiness. “This activity ensures that what was built can be operated. It includes planning, testing, onboarding, documentation handovers, risk mitigation, and cultural alignment

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			between teams. The 'transition' activity may also involve onboarding external suppliers [...]” Ref 7.1.1 D. Incorrect. Waiting for issues to occur contradicts proactive transition practices. “A successful transition means that a product solution goes live in a meaningful, observable, supportable, and sustainable way.” Ref 7.1.1
31	C	7.1.2	A. Incorrect. Deployment management concerns moving components into live environments. It does not primarily provide visibility into the health and performance of live products and services. “Deployment management practice: The practice of moving new or changed hardware, software, documentation, processes, or any other service component to one of the controlled environments.” Ref Glossary B. Incorrect. Release management ensures availability of new or changed services. It does not primarily monitor or provide visibility into operational health and performance. “Release management practice: The practice of making new and changed services and features available for use.” Ref Glossary C. Correct. This practice directly enables visibility into the health and performance of live products and services. “Monitoring and event management: Monitoring and reporting of the service’s operational status, processing of events.” Ref 8.3, Table 8.2 D. Incorrect. Business analysis focuses on defining needs and requirements, not on operational monitoring. “Business analysis practice: The practice of analysing a business or some element of a business, defining its needs and recommending solutions to address these needs and/or solve a business problem, and create value for stakeholders. Ref Glossary
32	D	7.2.1	A. Incorrect. Roadmaps and backlogs are outputs of ‘discover’, not ‘operate’. “The key outputs of this activity include refined backlogs, updated product roadmaps, continual improvement initiatives, as well as reports and documentation of findings from the activity.” Ref 3.2.2 B. Incorrect. Supplier contracts and allocated resources are outputs of ‘acquire’, not ‘operate’. The key outputs of this activity are “Acquired resources and services.” Ref 5.1, Table 5.1 C. Incorrect. Prototyping and design changes belong to the ‘design’ activity. The key outputs of this activity are “Product specifications and prototypes.” Ref 4.1, Table 4.1 D. Correct. The ‘operate’ activity is concerned with running products and services in live environments and monitoring their performance. Its outputs therefore include

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
			operational data and performance information, showing how well products and services are functioning during use. The key outputs of this activity are “Operating products and services. Product performance records and reports.” Ref 8.1, Table 8.1
33	C	7.2.2	A. Incorrect. Ignoring recurring errors contradicts the intent of daily health checks and early detection. “An important trend in digital product operations is the shift from reactive to proactive approach and to closer integration with other stages of the digital product and service lifecycle.” Ref 8.1 B. Incorrect. Delaying action increases risk and does not align with immediate execution guidance. “Effective product operation is a key factor of service reliability.” Ref 8.1 C. Correct. This directly reflects execution of operational plans and reporting. ‘Operate’ includes routine operational tasks such as monitoring and maintenance that prevent incidents: “This includes routine operational tasks such as monitoring, performance tuning, backups, housekeeping, and technical maintenance that prevent incidents and service degradation.” Also, “When the health-check surfaces an issue, it is escalated according to a predefined runbook.” Ref 8.1.2, Ref 8.2.1.3 D. Incorrect. Disabling alerts contradicts the purpose of monitoring during ‘operate’, which is to capture and process events, not suppress them. The ‘operate’ activity: “Monitoring of the product health, Capturing and processing relevant events.” Ref 2.1.1, Table 2.1.
34	C	7.3.2	A. Incorrect. Introducing AI without structured data risks amplifying noise rather than improving operations. “Many organizations try to implement AI before organizing their operational data landscape.” Ref 8.4.3 B. Incorrect. Raising thresholds may hide symptoms but does not address underlying data quality issues. “The architecture of data, the modelling of observability, and proper event hygiene must all come first.” Ref 8.4.3 C. Correct. The guidance states that data architecture, modelling, and event hygiene must come before any AIOps initiative to avoid failure. “Many organizations try to implement AI before organizing their operational data landscape.” Ref 8.4.3 D. Incorrect. Replacing tools without addressing data quality repeats the same operational weaknesses. “Buying tools because they’re trendy, without a clear outcome in mind, is a fast track to failure.” Ref 8.4.3

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
35	A	9.1.2	A. Correct. The 'support' activity handles user issues, requests, and queries. The practice that directly performs this function is the service desk, which acts as the primary point of contact between users and the organization. "Service desk: Communicating with users requiring support." Ref 10.3, Table 10.2 B. Incorrect. Service level management focuses on agreements and targets, not handling user queries. It ensures that "recovery times and resolutions align, and feedback is gathered for continual improvement." Ref 10.3, Table 10.2 C. Incorrect. Release management ensures controlled introduction of changes but does not directly manage user issues or queries. "Release management: Ensuring that changes and releases are introduced in a controlled way that support teams can manage." Ref 10.3, Table 10.2 D. Incorrect. Problem management focuses on root causes, not direct handling of queries. It is often "Investigating incidents, detecting product and service errors and initiating improvements." Ref 10.3, Table 10.2
36	C	9.2.2	A. Incorrect. This is a metric of 'operate', not an output of 'support'. "Live products' reliability, performance, and information security." Ref 8.1, Table 8.1 B. Incorrect. This is a key output of 'build'. "Built and tested product solutions." Ref 6.1, Table 6.1 C. Correct. The 'support' activity's contribution to the digital product and service lifecycle is not just keeping services running, but capturing knowledge and insights from user interactions, incidents, and service requests, which then inform continual improvement across the lifecycle. "The 'support' activity aims to restore normal work and use of the product and related services as quickly and safely as possible when something goes wrong or when users need help, while learning from each case to prevent recurrence. This includes structured processes for handling incidents and disasters, as well as integration with problem management and continual improvement." Ref 10.1.2 D. Incorrect. This is the outcome of 'transition'. "Products, services, and resources deployed to the target live environment and ready for operation." Ref 7.1, Table 7.1

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
37	D	9.2.1	A. Incorrect. That action belongs to the first step, not the final step. Step 1 is "Identify and assess incidents and disasters." Ref 10.2 B. Incorrect. Blame-focused reviews undermine systemic improvement and psychological safety. "The 'support' activity aims to restore normal work and use of the product and related services as quickly and safely as possible when something goes wrong or when users need help, while learning from each case to prevent recurrence." Ref 10.1.2 C. Incorrect. Adjusting alerts may help detection but does not address root causes or learning. "All improvement items, from updating run-books to fine-tuning anomaly thresholds, are automatically entered into the backlog." Ref 10.2.1.3 D. Correct. The 'support' activity concludes with structured reviews, metrics analysis, and logging improvement actions into backlogs to prevent recurrence. "Review and report support actions." Ref 10.2
38	B	9.3.2	A. Incorrect. Delaying communication increases frustration and contradicts effective support practices. "Once an incident is classified, the responsible lead activates [...] external communication, and security for breach considerations." Ref 10.2.1.2 B. Correct. Engaging users during an incident and restoring service using structured support pathways aligns directly with these recommendations. "Provide real-time status indicators for ongoing incidents, giving users immediate visibility into whether their issue is isolated or part of a larger outage." Also, "offer multiple resolution pathways (self-serve, guided walkthroughs, or live agent chat), allowing users to choose the level of assistance that matches their comfort and urgency." Ref 10.4.3 C. Incorrect. Escalating to product design before restoring service does not align with immediate incident response actions. Product improvements follow resolution rather than replace it. "Integrate the survey insights into the product roadmap backlog, ensuring that recurring pain points are addressed by product teams rather than being endlessly patched by support." Ref 10.4.3 D. Incorrect. Ignoring user communication undermines trust during incidents. "For every third-party component (such as a payment gateway, CDN, or SaaS API),[...] stakeholders and customers receive consistent, timely updates." Ref 10.4.1

Question	Answer	Assessment Criteria	Rationales
39	B	10.1.5	A. Incorrect. This has to do with 'support', not product management. "Resolving incidents and restoring normal product operation and service delivery" Ref 10.3, Table 10.2 B. Correct. Effective digital product management is cross-functional and dependent on ongoing collaboration across roles. This is reinforced as a critical success factor across lifecycle management activities (especially 'design' and 'build'). "Customers, product managers, designers, engineers, service professionals, and other stakeholders must collaborate early and often, and make their work visible." Ref 3.4.1 C. Incorrect. This has to do with 'operate'. A key output is "Product performance records and reports." Ref 8.1, Table 8.1 D. Incorrect. Effective product management embeds governance into everyday delivery work rather than relying on centralized formal approval of every product change. "Policy-as-code, data-lineage and model-governance controls, and standardized decision-rights documented in a concise governance handbook embed compliance and ethics into everyday delivery work." Ref 11.1
40	B	10.1.3	A. Incorrect. Value streams may include only the activities required to create value in a given context. Value streams "are the actual sequence of activities performed, rather than a predetermined blueprint." This indicates that not all value streams include every lifecycle stage. Ref 11.4 B. Correct. Value streams are contextual and flexible. They are defined based on how value is created and consumed, not as fixed sequences. "Organizations select the product and service management activities they will be responsible for, and this defines their service offering." Ref 11.4.1 C. Incorrect. Value streams differ based on organizational context and operating model. Real "world workflows, although based on established processes and other workflows, are always unique." Ref 11.4 D. Incorrect. Value streams are designed to align with value creation and business models, not to optimize internal efficiency in isolation. "Value stream mapping and management optimize the flow of work and value creation for customers and other stakeholders." Ref 11.4.4

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